

# What to Build Next

Everything in this report is read off TrustMRR.

TrustMRR is a public database of startups whose revenue is verified: founders connect their Stripe, RevenueCat or Paddle account and their monthly number goes on record, refreshed hourly. Many of the same businesses are simultaneously listed for sale with an asking price.

That makes it the closest thing there is to an open order book for small software businesses — and the basis for everything that follows: what is being solved, what is growing, and where the openings are.

**\$1.51B**

verified revenue on TrustMRR

**53M**

payment transactions behind it

**5,000+**

startups with revenue on record

*Written to be read alone. No presenter required.*

# ■ What TrustMRR is

One site does three jobs at once. Each one tells a builder something different.

## A leaderboard

Founders connect their payment account and their monthly revenue goes public, refreshed hourly. Nobody types a number in by hand.

## A marketplace

Many of the same businesses are simultaneously listed for sale — with an asking price and a multiple attached to them.

## A field log

Every listing carries its category, its tech stack, and the channel it uses to find customers. That last field is the valuable one.

## What it proves — and what it hides

Revenue is pulled straight from Stripe, RevenueCat, Superwall, Paddle, LemonSqueezy, Polar and Creem, so the numbers are hard. The selection is not: only founders with something worth showing sign up, and businesses that quietly failed never appear. Read every figure here as a map of what is working — never as a measure of how likely it is to work.

# ■ How to read it

Five ways to mine the site. The leaderboard is the least useful page on it.

1

**Read the for-sale listings, not the rankings.**

Sellers disclose revenue, costs, margin and why they are leaving. It is a free teardown of a business that already works, written by the person who ran it.

2

**Hunt for the third company doing the same thing.**

One is a fluke. Two is a coincidence. Three separate people making money the same way is demand you can trust without asking anyone.

3

**When the winners in a category share one channel, that channel is the moat.**

The barrier to entry is not the product. It is whatever it took them to own that channel — and that is what you'd have to beat.

4

**A high-revenue business listed for sale is usually a service wearing software clothing.**

Before copying the model, work out what a human has to do every month. Either avoid it or make automating that the whole product.

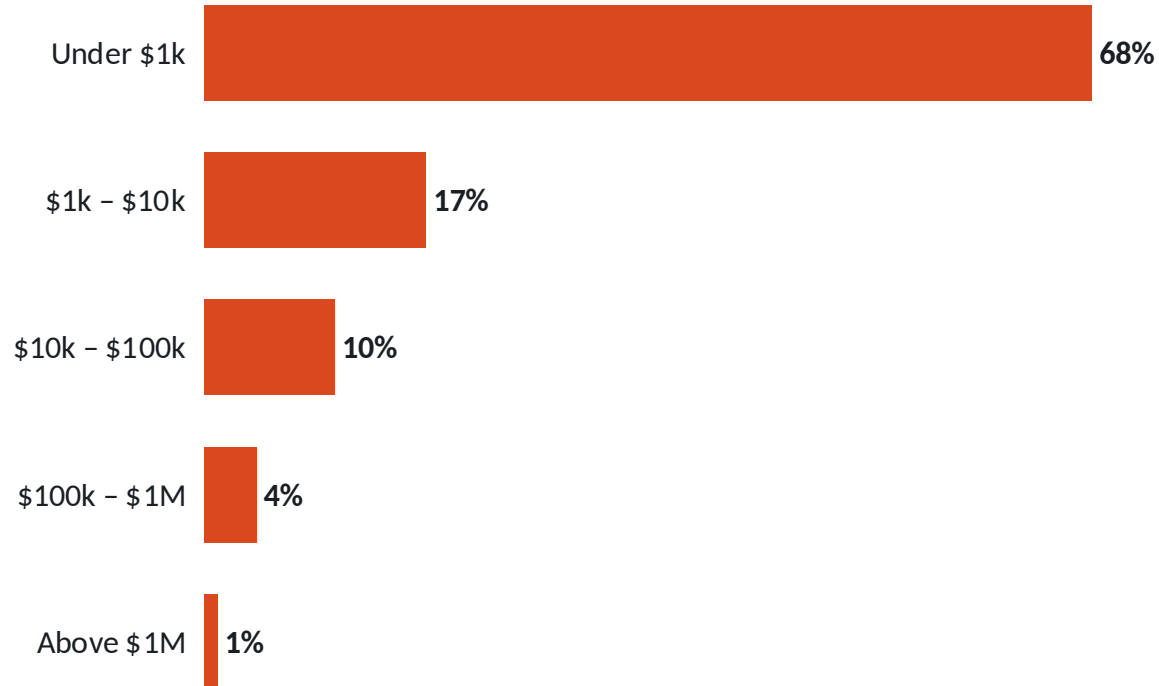
5

**Shared tech stacks across the top names mean speed is table stakes.**

If everyone can ship the same thing in a week, shipping fast is not an advantage. Assume the build takes days and the distribution takes a year.

## ■ Revenue distribution of listed startups

Almost nothing here is big — and that is the useful part.



Share of all listed startups, by monthly revenue. Figures rounded.

**Roughly six in seven listed businesses have never passed \$10,000 a month.**

### So set the target honestly

The realistic prize is \$5,000–20,000 a month: one person, no funding, no team, and an asset that can be sold.

That is a good outcome — but it demands the opposite decisions from a venture path. It means pricing for margin instead of adoption, automating instead of hiring, and choosing a market small enough that nobody funded is coming for it.

Most 0-1 attempts fail on this slide, not on the idea.

# ■ What is being solved

Four clusters, sorted by the problem rather than the label the founder chose.

## Sell the finished work

AI that hands back a deliverable instead of a workspace.

*Live: ad videos, thumbnails, résumés, outreach sequences, listing photos*

## Get found by machines

Search has split in two: ranking on Google, and being the source an AI answer quotes.

*Live: autonomous SEO agents, answer-engine tools, content pipelines*

## Boring verified data

An API or feed that somebody must have and nobody wants to maintain.

*Live: phone and email validation, property records, compliance logs*

## Picks and shovels for creators

Infrastructure for people who already have attention and need to convert it.

*Live: storefronts, multi-platform posting, creator-owned physical brands*

## ■ Outcome vs. workspace

The businesses that work sell an outcome delivered.

The ones that stall sell a workspace to operate.

### Price the outcome

A finished ad video is priced against what an agency charges, not against what a tool charges. Same code, five times the price.

### Value in five minutes

Onboarding is a form, not a tutorial. If the first result takes a setup call, the trial is already dead.

### Ugly is allowed

Nobody grades the interface of something that hands back a finished file. Spend the design budget on the output, not the dashboard.

## ■ Category growth, last 30 days

Movement in listed revenue by category — growth is loudest where the base is smallest.

**Customer support** ~93%

**Education** ~63%

**Social media** ~36%

**Content creation** ~28%

**SaaS** ~26%

**Entertainment** ~22%

**E-commerce** ~17%

## The honest read

A large percentage on a small base is a category waking up, not a category won. Ranking by growth alone will walk you into the emptiest rooms.

The two places where growth and existing size overlap are content creation and e-commerce. That overlap is the entry point.

Customer support is the loudest signal and the most crowded pitch in the market at the same time. Entering it needs a wedge — a specific industry, a specific channel, a specific integration — not a better chatbot.

Education's jump is worth a second look for a different reason: it is the one category where an individual with credibility can outrun a funded team.

## ■ What these businesses sell for

Marketplace listings typically ask around two to two and a half times annual revenue.

**2 – 2.5×**

annual revenue — the going asking  
multiple

**Which means a product doing \$1,000 a month is an asset worth roughly \$25,000.**

*Small is not the same as pointless. It is inventory.*

### ■ Build for the buyer from week one.

Documented, no manual monthly steps, no dependency on you personally. That is the whole difference between an asking price of one times and two and a half.

### ■ Treat anything under one times as a warning.

Cheap multiples usually mean a human is doing the work behind the product. Find out what that human does before you copy the business.

### ■ Consider running the trade in reverse.

At these prices, buying a working \$500–2,000 a month product and pointing your distribution at it beats starting from zero.

## ■ Audience size vs. revenue

The most common reason people give for not starting does not survive contact with the evidence.

### More than half

of the founders listed have fewer than 1,000 followers on X. Several businesses above \$1M in revenue belong to founders with double-digit follower counts.

### The trap on the other side

Founders with large audiences often build the wrong thing, because their launch always works. Starting without one forces you to find a channel that keeps working after the first week.

Audience size and revenue barely track each other here. An audience is a shortcut, not a prerequisite — it lets you skip the first hundred customers, nothing more.

If you do not have one, you are not behind. You simply have to pick a channel that does not require one:

- Search — including being cited by AI assistants
- App stores and software marketplaces
- Integrations inside someone else's product
- Cold outbound to a list you can name

# ■ What correlates with revenue

Two things track it far more closely than anything about the founder.

## How long it has existed

Revenue climbs with age more reliably than with any other visible factor. Nothing here compounds in month three.

## How strong its domain is

Search authority tracks revenue almost as closely. Distribution built once keeps paying; distribution rented stops the day you stop.

## What to do with that

### 1 Pick one channel and hold it for eighteen months.

Three channels for six weeks each is the most common way a working product quietly dies.

### 2 Expect the unglamorous ones to win.

Search, written content, Reddit, cold email, affiliates and integrations are what the listed businesses actually run on.

### 3 Treat being quoted by AI assistants as a second, separate job.

Most incumbents are still optimising only for the ten blue links. That gap closes fast — it is open now.

## ■ Revenue by country

Verified revenue by country of the founder.

|                |        |
|----------------|--------|
| United States  | \$1.2B |
| Poland         | \$86M  |
| France         | \$24M  |
| United Kingdom | \$22M  |
| Canada         | \$10M  |
| Singapore      | \$8M   |
| India (11th)   | \$4.2M |

## Two things worth noticing

Poland sitting second, ahead of every large economy except the United States, tells you this list is not measuring economies. A concentrated builder scene — or a handful of large businesses — is enough to move a whole country up it.

India at eleventh is not a ceiling, it is an absence. The customers in this market are global and pay in dollars; the cost base can sit anywhere. Almost nobody here is playing this particular game, which is strange given how many people here can ship.

The practical version: you are not competing with your city. You are competing with a few thousand people worldwide, most of whom are working alone and part-time.

# ■ Six ideas worth exploring

Judgement, not evidence — each one is a gap between what exists and who is served.

## Answer-engine visibility for local services

The tools that get you cited by AI assistants sell to software companies. Clinics, law firms, brokers and contractors have the identical problem and no vendor.

**First customer: anyone already paying for SEO.**

## A vertical ad-video factory

Generic AI video-ad tools are crowded. One industry — with its own hooks, its own compliance rules and its own template library — is not.

**First customer: brands running paid social weekly.**

## Verified-data APIs for Indian rails

Phone, email and identity validation is a large business globally. GST numbers, UPI handles, addresses and documents are the same shape, closer to home.

**First customer: teams writing this in-house today.**

## Compliance software for one unloved niche

A top-20 business here sells records and compliance software to care providers. The shape repeats wherever paperwork is mandatory and the incumbent is a spreadsheet.

**First customer: an operator who fails an audit yearly.**

## Operations for creator-owned products

Storefront, fulfilment and payouts for creators launching physical goods is proven abroad and largely unbuilt for creators here.

**First customer: 100k followers, no supply chain.**

## Buy instead of build

A working product doing \$1,000 a month costs roughly \$25,000. If your real edge is distribution, skip the zero-to-one entirely.

**First customer: the one the seller already has.**

# ■ Five tests for an idea

Each one comes with the condition that should kill it.

**1 Does it hand back a finished thing?**

Kill it if the honest answer is "it helps them do it themselves."

**2 Can you find a third company doing it?**

Kill it if you cannot find two competitors. You are not early, you are alone.

**3 Can one channel carry it for eighteen months?**

Kill it if the plan is content and ads and outbound and partnerships.

**4 Does it work at \$5,000–20,000 a month?**

Kill it if the model only makes sense at a scale you will never reach solo.

**5 Would someone pay two times revenue for it without you in the room?**

Kill it if the answer depends on you personally being there.

*If an idea survives all five, the remaining risk is execution — which is the only risk worth taking.*

# ■ Limits of this report

- Everything here is one snapshot.

Figures were taken on 6 August 2026 and move daily. Re-check anything you plan to act on.

- Revenue is verified; labels are not.

Payment providers confirm the money. Category, tech stack and channel are declared by the founder.

- This is a record of survivors.

Businesses that failed quietly never appear. Nothing here says how likely any of it is to work — only what worked.

- Percentages move on small bases.

A category jumping by half may have added one business. Direction is meaningful; magnitude often is not.

- The openings and the filter are judgement.

They are conclusions drawn from the pattern, not facts read off it. Argue with them.

*Source: trustmrr.com — a public database of startup revenues verified through connected payment providers.*